Elizabeth Ortega

Product Designer · Research, Design & Prototyping

Seeking Summer 2027 internships and full-time roles

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EDUCATION

Pomona College – Claremont, CA — Expected May 2027

BA in Cognitive Science and Media Studies | Concentration: Human Centered Design Engineering

Study Abroad: DIS – Copenhagen, Denmark — Jan 2026 – May 2026

Relevant coursework: Usability Testing & Interactive Design (Claremont Graduate University), Intro to Human Centered Design, Design & Equity, Usable Security & Privacy, Interactive Media Studio, Digital Fabrication, Experimental Design & Stats, Intro to CS (Python)

SKILLS

Design: Interaction & UI Design, Rapid Prototyping, Design Systems, Information Architecture, Content Design, Game & Level Design, 3D Modeling/Printing

Research: User Interviews (English & Spanish), Moderated Usability Testing, Focus Groups, Competitive Audits, Journey Mapping, Experimental Design, Data Analysis

Tools: Figma, FigJam, Claude, Framer, Adobe Creative Cloud (Photoshop, Illustrator), Miro, Canva, Lucidchart, Unity, Lens Studio, Tinkercad, Vercel, Replit

Technical & Languages: Python, HTML/CSS, MS Excel, PowerPoint | Native Spanish speaker

EXPERIENCE

Green Jobs Board, Product Design Intern – Remote — Jun – Aug 2025; Jun 2026 – Present

- Helped turn a jobs list into a knowledge hub over two summers, designing the **Compass Career Quiz**, now live: wrote its questions and "green personalities," which route job seekers to 2–3 matching career pathways and guides.
- Showcased the quiz at a **sold-out, 700-person Green Summit**, where over half of attendees wanted to pivot into climate, the quiz's exact audience; researched and wrote the Blueprint pathway posters shown there.
- Co-led content strategy and IA for **10 Treehouse Guides** (10–15 pages each), then designed the guide and pathway pages using needs from a 30-person focus group I facilitated.
- Tested Green Jobs Board 2.0 as a job seeker across Safari and Chrome and wrote a UX roadmap with a design fix for each issue; **15 of my 21 fixes shipped** in the launch, plus 11 issues logged across seeker, employer and admin views.
- Grounded the work in research (15+ platform audits, bilingual trainee interviews, field research at GRID Alternatives), and the project was featured by The Hive. Also designed the 2.0 demo video and launch posts; now proposing guides that work as workspaces.

Cara AI, Growth Marketing Intern – Remote — Jun 2026 – Present

- Produce cross-platform creative for a multi-channel acquisition campaign, researching competitor visual styles to design and deploy assets toward a 1,000-assessment goal.
- Map digital journeys and user flows for the HomeScan launch, running user surveys and onboarding friction audits that turn behavioral insights into copy and layout improvements.

Harvey Mudd College, Makerspace Steward – Claremont, CA — Aug 2025 – Present

- Run advanced fabrication facilities and consult on CAD and rapid prototyping tools, supporting 100+ student engineering and design projects.

Periamma, UX Intern – Copenhagen, Denmark — Jan 2026 – May 2026

- Redesigned Periamma's website from scratch, mapping navigation and user flows so a new brand identity worked with legacy functionality.
- Streamlined newsletter and contact flows with third-party API integrations (Mailchimp, Resend, Simply), driving a **52% lower bounce rate** and a **168% increase in visitors**.

Waymo × LA-Tech, Project Lead – Los Angeles, CA — Nov 2025 – Dec 2025

- Led a team analyzing severe-weather scenarios to develop AV interface proposals that support driver decision-making and safety.

LA-Tech, Lead Product Design Intern (Rising Internship) – Los Angeles, CA — Aug 2025 – Nov 2025

- Sole designer on a remote, six-person team; designed **Nodo**, an encrypted organizing app for grassroots activists that won the **LA-Tech Innovation Award**.
- Led interviews with organizers and translated them into four design principles and a feature framework: role-based permissions to reduce burnout, end-to-end encryption, data-retention controls and language localization.
- Built and tested an end-to-end functional prototype in Replit, leading live technical walkthroughs to keep cross-functional work aligned.

Snap Inc., Augmented Reality Extern – Remote Jul 2025 – Aug 2025

- Ideated 25 concepts, then designed and programmed an interactive AR Lens in Lens Studio (face/body mesh, segmentation, physics, 3D modeling), using 3 usability tests to improve performance and narrative clarity.

Miss EmpowHer, Web & Graphic Design Intern – Remote May 2025 – Aug 2025

- Designed 30+ digital assets for Shopify-integrated platforms and 12+ events, including social flyers for events that sold out across the U.S. and internationally, and optimized the website and link-in-bio pages, contributing to a 25% engagement increase among 1,000+ attendees.

SELECTED PROJECTS

Fix It in Post-It, Game Designer & Developer (Unity) – Interactive Media Studio Oct 2026

- Designed and built a 3-level pixel-art platformer, **released free on itch.io**, that makes the "empathize" stage of human-centered design playable: each mechanic recreates a real campus frustration, then ends on a "How might we…" question.
- Built as a teaching tool for ~40 club members and Intro to HCD students (~20 per section), and as a conversation starter with administrators; studied Celeste and Flappy Bird to make effort something players feel.

USPS PO Box Rental Redesign, UX Researcher & Designer – Claremont Graduate University 15-day sprint

- Built a replica of usps.com and ran moderated think-aloud tests with 5 new renters: **80% couldn't find the rental flow** (77 seconds searching on average), yet everyone who reached it finished.
- Redesigned the path in with a Figma prototype: Quick Tools sorted by task, a homepage task card for PO Boxes, and a side-by-side size comparison.

Digital Fabrication Series, Pomona College Fall 2025

- Made three pieces on memory and perception with 3D scanning, printing and moldmaking, including *Drifting Outside Myself*, a 3D-printed, LED-lit brain installation viewers peer into.

LEADERSHIP & COMMUNITY

World Studios (f.k.a. Design for America), Studio Lead – Claremont, CA Mar 2026 – Present

- Lead end-to-end design sprints, community outreach, partnerships and workshops for the Claremont Colleges' campus design lab.
- Designed and facilitated the Problem Fair for 30 members (5 rounds, 5 categories), which produced the 7 problem spaces the club is pursuing this year; designed and built our recruiting site.

Management Leadership for Tomorrow (MLT), West Coast Recruiter

- Recruit first-generation and underrepresented students on the West Coast into MLT's career development programs.

Pomona College, Cultural Communities & Mentorship Programming Intern – Claremont, CA Aug 2024 – Present

- Co-developed inclusive programming for 400+ First Gen, LGBTQ+, South Asian and Undocumented/DACA students; analyzed survey data to refine outreach, boosting engagement by 25%.
- Came up with and hosted a community art event to connect the affinity groups' newly relocated salas, where students painted pieces for their own spaces.

Pomona College, First Generation & Low Income Mentor and Sponsor Apr 2024 – May 2025

- Mentored 21 first-year students through their transition to college; received the Sagehen Award for leadership and impact in the sponsor program.

Rare Impact by Rare Beauty, College Ambassador & Team Creative Lead – Remote Jul 2024 – Dec 2024

- Prototyped The Heartful Mailbox, a free-writing reflection tool for a national mental health campaign, shared at the Rare Beauty Mental Health Summit.

Pomona College, Cognitive Science & Linguistics Department Liaison Aug 2024 – May 2025

- Designed department merchandise in Procreate and Illustrator and organized monthly workshops and research symposiums for 50+ attendees.

State of Mind Project, Director of Design & Outreach – Remote Apr 2021 – May 2023

- Led the design team for a youth mental health nonprofit, building reusable brand assets and 3–5 infographics a week across 600+ hours, growing the audience by 500 followers.

AWARDS

LA-Tech Rising Internship Innovation Award (2025) · Featured by the Sontag Center for Collaborative Creativity, The Hive (2025) · Sagehen Award, Pomona College (2024) · President's Volunteer Service Award (2023) · 1,800+ hours of community service